



ActiveShade

5.1.1 Render scene window

Much of the rendering process in 3ds Max is controlled in the Render Scene window (choose Rendering > Render). This window has several tabs. The first is a Common panel that you can use to specify the size and format of the render, the filenames, and other options. It also lets you assign the renderer.

The Renderer tab is unique to the type of renderer selected. Other tabs will also appear, depending on the type of renderer selected.

5.1.2 ActiveShade window

ActiveShade provides interactive rendering for 3ds Max. ActiveShade updates the render as parameters such as lighting and materials are changed. A floating ActiveShade window can be created by using the ActiveShade icon on the main toolbar. Viewports also have an option to be displayed as ActiveShade. You can drag and drop materials from the Material Editor to an ActiveShade window as you can with other viewports.



ActiveShade window

ActiveShade does have a few limitations. Only one ActiveShade window can be active at a time. Changes to geometry will not update in the ActiveShade window, and it will not render atmospheric effects, rendering effects, or raytraced shadows.

5.2 Object properties

Each object in the scene has object properties applied to it. Some of these options determine how the object appears in the scene, but they also control how the object is rendered. To access the Object Properties panel, go to Edit > Object Properties, or by right-click on an object (or objects) and select Object Properties from the object's quad menu.